

7.4 Using the Motion Panel

The Motion panel is a place where you can assign controllers, set keyframes, and manage motion. The panel can be considered a close cousin of the modifier stack. Whereas the modifier stack allows you to add modifiers to change the shape or character of an object, the Motion panel allows you to configure and animate controllers that shape the character of the object's motion.

7.4.1 Parameter Mode

Parameter mode displays an object's controllers and allows you to change or modify them. You can also set and manage keys for key framable controllers and adjust parameters for other types of controllers.

7.4.2 Trajectory Mode



The spaceship will follow the specified trajectory

Trajectory mode displays an object's trajectory through a scene. This can be very helpful in visualizing an object's motion. The panel allows you to add and delete keys as well as move, rotate, and scale keys. You can convert a spline path to a trajectory or create a trajectory from an existing spline path.

7.5 Using Track View

Once set, keys can be edited to fine-tune the look and feel of the scene. Simple editing can be done on the timeline by selecting and moving keys or right-clicking them to bring up their controller properties. Keys can also be edited in the Motion panel as well as in the Curve Editor and Dope Sheet. Track View is the interface where you can edit animation for multiple objects as well as assign and edit controllers. The window has two modes: the Curve Editor and the Dope Sheet.

- **Tangent Types**

These buttons change the type of tangent on the selected keys.

- **Curve Tangents**

Tangents can be adjusted by using the Bezier handles.